

States, Territories & Indigenous Nations

Territory to State - Followed by Annual Audits - §15.1-§15.3

§15.1

Territory

Elected local authority, Article I protections, social-state access, proportional Assembly seats (no Senate seats). May begin the Statehood pathway.

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§15.2 · THE AUDIT

Statehood Audit

Each Monitor publishes its domain finding. Overall failure requires material failure in at least two domains. One material finding is a warning requiring remediation, not an overall failure (§15.2).

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§15.2

Full Statehood

Passing confers Statehood immediately by constitutional operation. Two Senate seats arise; the Panel assigns distinct existing classes by lot and holds a special election within 90 days. There is no Provisional entry stage.

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§15.3 · DECLINE

Mandatory Devolution

First failure: warning and remediation. Second: renewed warning and revised plan. Third: Provisional status; the State remains a State. Sitting senators finish, but no new Senate term starts. Devolution still requires a referendum and agreement.

The Voluntary Exits - §15.4, §15.9

Devolution & Merger §15.4

60% vote · at least 50% turnout / 2/3 Senate ratifies

Voluntary and mandatory routes use the same process: 60% vote with at least 50% participation, negotiation with the Legislature, then 2/3 Senate ratification. A completed devolution produces a Territory. Provisional-State referenda begin at the first sitting senator's term expiry and repeat every two years if unresolved.

Independence §15.9

2/3 legislature / 60% vote, 60% turnout / national approval required

State approval starts the process: both federal chambers must then ratify at 60% within 90 days, excluding the petitioning State's members. A national vote follows within 180 days: 60% approval, 50% participation. A negotiated separation agreement needs 2/3 Senate ratification. The five-year bar applies to a failed Stage One vote (§15.9).

Indigenous Nations - Sovereignty Acknowledged, Not Granted - §16.1-§16.5

Prior sovereignty, recognized §16.1 · Bilateral Compact

Indigenous sovereignty precedes the Republic. During the founding window, nations choose through their own lawful process. No election means interim Associated Community treatment, without implied consent to unaccepted Compact terms. Territorial Integration permanently ends the former status; a later sovereign relationship requires a new Compact. Predecessor treaties continue (§§16.1-16.5).

Numbers Worth Remembering

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political votes to become a State - the Audit alone decides (§15.2).

2

consecutive annual audits with no material failure by any Monitor restore ordinary State status (§15.1.a).

3

consecutive overall failures place an existing State in Provisional status (§15.3).

60%

devolution approval, with at least 50% turnout. Independence requires its separate State, federal-chamber, national-vote, and agreement stages (§15.9).